

Year 4 Reading Comprehension - Cultural Festival Day

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E4LY05 - use comprehension strategies to build literal and inferred meaning, expand ideas and evaluate texts.

Learning Intention

Read a realistic text and identify key details, character actions and inferred meaning.

Reading Strategy

Pause after each paragraph and ask: What happened? Why did it matter?

Vocabulary Helper

volunteer - a person who helps without being paid

stall - a small table or stand used to display things

tradition - a custom or belief passed on over time

Cultural Festival Day

On Saturday morning, the school oval was transformed into a bright cultural festival. Flags fluttered along the fence, music floated from the stage and families carried plates of food from many different places. Mina arrived early with her grandmother, who had agreed to volunteer at the storytelling stall.

At first, Mina felt nervous. She had practised reading a short welcome, but the microphone looked enormous. Her friend Arlo noticed her twisting the paper in her hands. 'Read it like you are talking to me,' he whispered. Mina took a slow breath and stepped forward.

After the welcome, visitors moved between stalls. Some students tried calligraphy, others learnt a simple dance, and a group of younger children listened to a story about a clever bird. Mina's grandmother explained that festivals help people share memories, languages and traditions.

By the end of the day, Mina was tired but proud. She had not only read clearly; she had helped people feel welcome. As she packed away the chairs, she realised that learning about others can make a community feel bigger and closer at the same time.

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Page 2 - Questions and written response

Warm Up - Quick check

Circle the type of text: Story / Information text / Poem

Build Your Skills

1. Where was the cultural festival held?

2. Why did Mina feel nervous at the beginning?

3. What did Arlo do to help Mina?

4. Name two activities visitors could try at the festival.

5. What did Mina learn about festivals and community?

6. Find one detail that shows Mina felt proud by the end.

Reading Challenge

Explain how Mina changed from the beginning to the end of the text. Use evidence from the passage.

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I can read carefully.
- ☐ I can use evidence.
- ☐ I can answer in full sentences.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____



High Five!

You noticed how a character changed over time. That is thoughtful reading!

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Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Warm Up answer: Story or realistic narrative.

Detailed answers

1. The festival was held on the school oval.
2. Mina felt nervous because she had to read a welcome using a microphone.
3. Arlo encouraged her by telling her to read as if she was talking to him.
4. Visitors could try calligraphy, learn a dance, listen to a story or visit food stalls.
5. She learnt that festivals help people share memories, languages and traditions, and can bring a community closer.
6. Answers may mention that Mina was tired but proud, read clearly or helped people feel welcome.

Challenge answer: Look for a clear comparison, such as Mina beginning nervous and ending proud, with evidence from the microphone scene and the final paragraph.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, ask your child to retell the story as a tiny news report. Add a silly microphone, such as a spoon, to make reading aloud feel fun.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Before independent answers, model one question by underlining key words and finding the sentence that proves the answer.

Extension Idea

Create a small festival poster showing one activity from the text and write two sentences explaining why it matters.